Shimon Rura

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Summary. Entrepreneurial product leader with deep expertise in data-driven biomedical research, AI agents, healthcare, and cloud computing. Strong track record of shipping new software products and growing product businesses. Currently open to select consulting engagements.

Employment

Product Lead, Workbench, Verily (formerly Google Life Sciences), 2018–2026. Led product for Verily's top commercial offering, with a team of 4 PMs and ∼30 engineers and designers. Workbench is a Trusted Research Environment (TRE) that enables biomedical researchers to easily leverage cloud-scale computational tools, while automatically enforcing data governance rules. It is used by tens of thousands of researchers and trusted by dozens of data providers including the *All of Us* Research Program of the National Institutes of Health.

As product lead, I was responsible for making sure the Workbench roadmap lined up with needs of our customers and market. During my time on Workbench, we took the product from idea to implementation, early customers, and then scaled the business into Verily's strongest revenue driver.

Before joining the Workbench team in 2020, I was product manager for Onduo, a chronic disease management product, where I led enrollment and built a mental health offering.

Consultant and Partner, Danger Fort Labs, 2016–2018. Partner in a consultancy that helps companies master product discovery. Clients included Harvard Business Publishing, the Christian Science Monitor, and early-stage startups in health, media, and manufacturing. Taught discovery by doing: partnering with client teams to drive rapid product progress while building their capacity to continue on their own.

CTO, Happie, 2015–2016. Led engineering for recruitment funnel automation product featuring live video, text messaging, and mobile-first web app. Hired and managed full-time and outsourced engineering and design staff. Took product from rough prototype to public launch, revenue, and thousands of users.

Director, Open Research Exchange, PatientsLikeMe, 2012–2015. Managed a cross-functional staff of 10 FTEs in designing, developing, and bringing to market a novel research platform integrated with the PatientsLikeMe patient community. Open Research Exchange (ORE), funded by the Robert Wood Johnson Foundation, enabled researchers to develop health outcome measures based on patient-reported data. Also built a scientific advisory board, spoke at conferences about novel approaches in Patient-Reported Outcomes, secured over $3M in funding for the project, and supported commercial measure development offerings.

Director of Product Management, Smarterer, 2011–2012. Responsible for developing and communicating product vision, defining and prioritizing features, tracking performance metrics, running user research, and helping management, dev, and design teams work together smoothly. Smarterer was acquired by Pluralsight for $75M.

Co-founder, NodeRabbit, Inc., 2010–2011. Created a Platform as a Service (PaaS) offering for the Django web framework. Acquired in 2022.

Earlier career. Software Development Consultant and Advisor, 2008–2011; Member of Technical Staff, Renesys Corp., 2005–2008; Software Engineer, Kronos, Inc., 2003–2005.

Publications

Bick, Metcalf, Mayo, Lichtenstein, **Rura**, Carroll, Musick, Linder, Jordan, Nagar, Sharma, and Meller (The All of Us Research Program Genomics Investigators). Genomic data in the *All of Us* Research Program. *Nature*, **627**, 340–346 (2024). doi:10.1038/s41586-023-06957-x.

Mayo, Basford, Carroll, Dillon, Fullen, Leung, Master, **Rura**, et al. The *All of Us* Data and Research Center: Creating a Secure, Scalable, and Sustainable Ecosystem for Biomedical Research. *Annual Review of Biomedical Data Science*, **6**, 443–464 (2023). doi:10.1146/annurev-biodatasci-122120-104825.

Education

Williams College. B.A. with honors, Computer Science.

Skills

Product Management & Strategy. Product vision and roadmaps, assumption mapping & prioritization, design sprints (as facilitator and participant), experimental measurement of value and commitment. Market and competitive research. Agile and Kanban methods.

Secure Data Platforms & Governance. Trusted Research Environments (TREs), tiered/controlled data access, policy enforcement, identity and credentialing, project/workspace isolation, cloud cost management (FinOps). Regulatory frameworks including HIPAA, FedRAMP, and NIST 800-53. Researcher tooling (Jupyter, RStudio, workflow engines) and GA4GH standards.

AI Agents. Agent development and deployment with LangChain/LangGraph and other toolkits; agent architecture and evaluation. Agentic tools (Claude Code, Codex, Hermes, OpenCode) for software development, prototyping, data analysis, market research, and documentation management.

User Research & Analytics. Study design, user interviewing, usability testing, wireframing and prototyping. Quantitative and qualitative goal-setting and evaluation. A/B testing.

Leadership & Business. Hiring and managing product managers, engineers, and designers. Product-level P&L. B2B and enterprise sales. Public speaking.

Technical. Python, JavaScript, SQL, Git, HTML/CSS. Google Cloud and AWS.

Activities & Achievements

- Mentored students in MIT course 6.171, Software Engineering for Internet Applications, February–May 2006. Co-taught a 3-day intensive course on relational databases at MIT IAP, January 2011 and January 2012.
- Board of Directors, Photo.net, 2006–2007. Acquired by NameMedia.
- Lead organizer of BarCamp Boston, an unconference for local techies, 2006–2014.
- Created Voo2do.com, a free online task tracker designed to be easy and fun to use. Over 150,000 registered users. 2005–2010.